my right, gathering the ball, springing to my feet, running towards the stumps and taking off the bails ... and then I look up and see the reality of Dale lying on the pitch, spent and devastated, Faf hiding his face in his palms, and Morné sitting on the grass, so still and so sad.

Maybe 20 seconds pass. Lose properly, I tell myself. So I take off my cap and start to walk around the field, either consoling teammates or congratulating New Zealanders on their victory. I am feeling OK, controlling my emotions well until I come across Dan Vettori, my friend and teammate from Royal Challengers Bangalore; he gives me a massive hug, which brings a lump to my throat and a few tears to my eyes.

'You didn't deserve to lose,' he says.

'It is fine,' I reply. 'Congratulations.'

I want to be strong. I want to show I can accept this disappointment. I compose myself, and continue going through the sporting rituals that follow every international, and finally reach the refuge of the visitors' dressing room at Eden Park. Our wives and families are starting to arrive. Danielle walks in with my parents. I hug her and hug my mother, and then I hug my father and, as he holds me in his arms, he says: 'It's not your fault, AB. It's not your fault.' And that is that. The tears start streaming from my eyes, as all the sadness and disappointment suddenly overflow.

I managed to recover and get through the post-match presentation ceremony, and I was still holding everything together when I embraced the ordeal of the media conference. Some journalists are knowledgeable, understanding and often humorous observers of the game; some can be less kind.

One of the latter breed took the microphone during the 'presser' and asked: 'AB, when you dropped the ball and failed to execute that run out, did you think you had dropped the World Cup?'

I replied: 'If you want to see it that way – that I cost us – then I will gladly take it.'